

THE PHXINDIA HANDBOOK

For all employees of Photographix, Motiongraphix, Stylefix and Studio Phix

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I. WHO ARE WE?

We are PHXINDIA — a multi-faceted visual documentation and communications Firm that speaks the language of aesthetics and quality with service standards to match.

PHXINDIA was born out of an idea that our founder and mentor Sebastian Zachariah started 20 years ago of establishing a studio specialised in the field of interior architecture photography. Now a reputed name known for providing high quality visuals to the interior, architecture, real estate and hospitality industries, PHXINDIA has managed to make a mark because of its ethics, work culture and the code of conduct we follow.

WHY THE PHX CODE?

To continue to operate and maintain our reputation and quality as a Firm, we must each learn, understand and comply with our Code. The Code is designed to ensure consistency in how employees conduct themselves. Complying with our code is about creating an environment where we can do our best work and be proud of it. No set of rules can cover all circumstances. Nothing in this Code should lead to the contravention of local laws, which, wherever contrary, will prevail. PHXINDIA LLP reserves the right to amend or alter the Code at any time and for any reason.

A code of ethics is broad, giving employees or members a general idea of what types of behaviour and decisions are acceptable and encouraged at a business or organisation. A code of conduct is more focused. It defines how employees or members should act in specific situations. To help navigate through this maze of expectations of correct behaviour and right conduct, we have listed and classified the Code into three main categories. Code of ethics, General and Professional Code of conduct. These are guidelines and ideas of acceptable and non-acceptable behaviour in various Scenarios that you might encounter in your day to day life at PHXINDIA. They are still 'work in progress' and changes will be added and points revised based on how things go from here on. Every employee is expected to comply with the Code as part of his or her employment duties.

II. WHAT DO WE BELIEVE IN?

At PHXINDIA...

We believe, we are an idea that is big and speaks many languages, across many states and many cultures. We are an idea without a boundary and in the truest term — universal. *We are an idea whose time has come!*

We believe that we are what we do and good quality and commitment will be the foundation of our very being. Our business shall be built on sound governance, best practises from across the world and within legal limits of the place where we are operating.

We believe in learning and relearning?. We think everything can be bettered and that the scope of improvement is intrinsic to all things in nature. So we will evolve, define and then redefine ourselves and our services for as long as we exist.

We believe that honesty is the best policy and will hold it as a core practise in everything we do.

We believe that loyal customers make sound business sense. We shall strive to build loyalty with our customers by delivering what we promise and getting better at it each time. We shall endeavour to listen more than we speak with our customers and shall be courteous with them at all times.

We believe that we shall profit from good systems and efficiency of our systems, and shall follow them for the benefit of the entire team and the business at large.

We believe that an effective system is nothing but people who deliver. Our associates and employees are our asset, and they shall be treated as such. Their loyalty is priceless and their commitment is stuff that can cross any obstacle. We will remain a human Firm and try to keep our people together and with us at all times.

We believe that whatever we do, it must finally benefit our customer. It is an improvement for either a better product, or service. Or even a better experience dealing with our Firm.

III. WHAT IS OUR PHILOSOPHY?

WE STAY CURIOUS

One of the most profound values of humanity is curiosity and a thirst for knowledge. We encourage questions, even if they don't lead to immediate answers.

WE HELP PEOPLE SHARE IDEAS AND BUILD KNOWLEDGE

All good things about humanity start with people sharing ideas. We think ideas matter and when that becomes knowledge, it has the potential to change the world. We want Team PHXINDIA to help every step of the way. We provide a platform for your ideas to become knowledge.

WE ENCOURAGE AESTHETICS

Whatever can be done should be done aesthetically. Communicating ideas should be stylish as well as functional. PHXINDIA inspires creative thinking, connects people through meaningful discussions, and help create beautiful outcomes. We help clients express themselves beautifully, within their idea of beauty.

WE PREFER SIMPLE THINGS

The value of Team PHXINDIA is not just a sum of its services. We've found that simplicity is actually hard to achieve, but in the end, it makes things much easier. Whether it's a new service offer or our employee benefits package, we try to stay focused and transparent by avoiding unnecessary complexity.

WE LISTEN

Listening—really listening—is harder than it seems. We believe that we have the most to learn from our clients. We value their ideas and our dialogue with them.

WE ENGAGE WITH OUR SURROUNDINGS

We're interested in the big picture as well as the things immediately close to us. Our product and our employees will try and cross barriers to improve the world around us. We are not afraid to take the side of the disadvantaged. We are looking at involving ourselves in charity as well as skill development programs wherever we are and hopefully this experience will helped us to better understand ourselves and our society.

WE GET IT DONE

We have big dreams and we know how to break them down into deliverable steps. Small improvements are often the best way to move mountains. In the marketplace, we compete vigorously, but we are always lawful and ethical. Our success depends on the trust of our customers. We all have an obligation to earn that trust every day.

WE'RE HONEST, LEARN FROM MISTAKES

Fear of making mistakes can squash innovation and creativity. At Team PHXINDIA, we create an environment where people dare to make and admit mistakes. We avoid blaming each other, and we take a critical view of ourselves. We like to openly discuss everything—including our weaknesses.

WE ADMIRE ART, MUSIC, AND GOOD FOOD

At PHXINDIA, we are diverse and are eager to learn about each other's interests. We believe that there is inspiration to be found in anything — whether it's a quirky hobby or an unlikely hero. Sure, we do these things because we value self-expression, but also because we'll never tire of learning about each other, ourselves, and the world.

WE KEEP OUR PROMISES

We honour our promises and do what is right, not just what is easy. Often it is easy to come up with excuses for why a promise wasn't kept. We acknowledge the uncertainties of the world, but when we make a commitment, we do our utmost to deliver on it.

IV. OUR CODE OF ETHICS

Some basic foundational Code of ethics on which PHXINDIA is based is as follows

- **We shall do no Evil. In all its interpretations, we shall never participate in or support anything that is intrinsically evil to humanity.**
- **We shall be transparent & ethical in our dealings. Be it within or outside the team.**
- **We shall strive for knowledge and improvement at all times. We are what we know!**
- **We shall act, behave and conduct ourselves as a professional at all times. We will deliver on our promises or not make a promise at all. We can be trusted and we know our job.**
- **We promise to 'belong' to the team and act as one. We will look out for the team at all times. Never shall we put them in any trouble and will always do everything to contribute valuably to their well being.**
- **We can find strength in diversity. Different people have different perspectives on issues, and that can be valuable for solving problems or generating new ideas.**

Employee Handbook

1. INTRODUCTION:

Welcome to PHX INDIA IMAGING SERVICES LLP (PHXINDIA)! We're glad to have you here. If you're reading this, we think you're a good fit for helping us fulfil our mission and achieve our goals.

This handbook was created to introduce you to PHXINDIA and provide information about working conditions, benefits, and policies essential to your employment here. The information you'll find in this handbook applies to all PHXINDIA employees.

Following the policies described in this handbook is a condition of your employment. However, nothing in this handbook alters an employee's status. Nothing in this handbook shall constitute nor be construed as a promise of employment or a contract between the Firm its employees.

The handbook is a summary of our policies, which are presented here for informational & guidance purposes. You are responsible for reading, understanding, and adhering to the provisions of this handbook. We hope to provide you with a work environment that is constructive to your personal and professional growth.

1.1 CHANGES IN POLICY.

This handbook replaces previous employee handbooks, memos, and manuals. We reserve the right to interpret, cancel, change, suspend, or dispute, with or without notice, all or any part of these policies, procedures, and benefits at any point. Employees will be notified of changes.

Changes take effect on dates determined by the Partners in the Firm. After changes take effect previous policies are void. Individual Team Leaders and managers cannot change policies but are free to make suggestions to the partners.

1.2 EMPLOYMENT APPLICATIONS.

We rely on the accuracy of employment application information and any other data candidates provide during the hiring process. Falsifications, misrepresentations, or material omissions may result in the exclusion of the candidate from consideration for employment. If the candidate has been hired, termination of employment may be considered. *Have you filled up your Bio-DATA sheet yet?*

NOTE : Employee personnel files include: job application, job description, résumé, records of training, salary history, records of disciplinary action and documents related to employee performance reviews, coaching, and mentoring. Personnel files are PHXINDIA LLP property. Access to information they contain is restricted. Only authorised personnel of PHXINDIA LLP who have a legitimate reason to review the file are allowed to do so. Final decision rests with admin and Partners.

1.3 EMPLOYMENT RELATIONSHIP.

You enter into this employment voluntarily, and are free to resign at any time for any reason or no reason. Likewise, PHXINDIA LLP is free to conclude its relationship with any employee at any time for any reason or no reason. Following the probationary period, employees are required to follow the Employment Termination Policy outlined in section 15.

1.4 NEW EMPLOYEE ORIENTATION.

Team Leaders and admin heads provide an orientation for new employees. This includes an overview of the Firm's history, an explanation of its vision, mission, values, goals and objectives. Orientation also includes an explanation of tax and legal issues, benefits, and help completing necessary paperwork.

Employees are presented with codes, keys, procedures, and secret handshakes needed to access their workspace. Supervisors introduce new hires to staff, explain Firm evaluation procedures, review position scope and job description, and help them start working.

1.5 NON-DISCLOSURE AND CONFIDENTIALITY AGREEMENT.

Protecting trade secrets and confidential business information is essential to the success of our Firm.

Such confidential information includes (but is not limited to): copyrights, client information and data, pending projects and proposals, proprietary production & post-production processes, compensation data, personnel/payroll records, financial information, marketing strategies, and conversations with people associated with the Firm.

As a condition of employment, employees must sign a non-disclosure agreement. The validity of the NDA is perpetual and is applicable even when the employee ceases to continue working in the firm. Employees improperly disclosing or using confidential business information or trade secrets are subject to disciplinary action, including termination and legal action, even if the disclosure does not benefit them.

1.6 NON-DISCRIMINATION.

PHXINDIA LLP does not discriminate in employment opportunities or practices because of race, sex, national origin, colour, religion, age or disability. We make reasonable accommodations for qualified individuals with known disabilities unless doing so would result in undue hardship.

1.7 PROBATIONARY PERIOD FOR NEW EMPLOYEES.

The probationary period for regular employees will vary from minimum 90 to maximum 180 days from the hire date. During the period, the management will evaluate new employees, and new employees can evaluate the Firm.

During the probationary period, the Firm and the employee can terminate employment without notice. Upon completion of the probationary period, a review will be given and benefits will begin as appropriate.

1.8 PERSONNEL DATA CHANGES.

Employees are responsible for notifying their supervisor or Admin of changes such as: mailing address, telephone number, name, number of dependents, and emergency contacts. An employee's personnel data should be accurate and current at all times.

1.9 PERFORMANCE REVIEW.

Supervisors give formal performance reviews every [six months]. Informal performance reviews may be conducted more often.

Performance reviews are for employees and supervisors to talk about current tasks and discuss ideas for meeting work goals. Performance is directly tied to wage and salary increases. Performance reviews will have a direct effect on your compensation.

2. EMPLOYEE STATUS

An “employee” of PHXINDIA LLP is a person who regularly works for PHXINDIA LLP on a wage or salary basis. “Employees” may include full time, part-time, temporary, contractual, associates and other employees who are subject to the control and supervision of the Firm in the performance of their duties.

TYPES OF EMPLOYEES:

A. DIVISIONS AND HIERARCHY / TEAMS

PHXINDIA LLP has 4 main divisions currently. They are as follows

- PHOTOGRAPHIX INDIA
- MOTIONGRAPHIX INDIA
- STYLEFIX INDIA
- STUDIO PHIX

The personnel at PHX INDIA LLP are divided into two groups, based on their nature of work and schedules.

B. PROFESSIONAL STAFF

This includes mostly technical staff, also referred to as “the crew”. Mostly outdoor, on-location work with no fixed timings and includes a fair bit of travelling.

The members of the professional staff or crew can include

1. Professionals (photographers, videographers, stylists)
2. Interns
3. Assistants
4. Associates
5. Consultants (art directors, set designers, production managers, etc)
6. Other professionals (drone pilots, sound recordists, make-up artists, etc)

C. SUPPORT STAFF

Includes technical staff as well as back office personnel. The technical as well as non-technical support staff usually spends more time in office and has hardly any outdoor duty unless otherwise asked to do so.

The members of the support staff include

- (1) Technicians (retouchers, post production)
- (2) Interns
- (3) Assistants
- (4) Associates (post processing houses, media managers)
- (5) Consultants (editors, sound designers, accountants)
- (6) Other professionals (customer relationship, admin and accounts personnel).

The rules for both the groups are similar but cannot be the same, given the nature of their duty and responsibilities. We have tried our best to balance both ends while keeping the law of the land, specific labour laws and rules that govern professional workforce in this country.

The Firm has particularly high expectations for those in management roles. It is especially important that you act as a role model for others by always following the Code, our policies and the law. Make sure that your team members understand their responsibilities and create a working environment where your team members respect the Code and feel comfortable to raise concerns.

3. OFFICE RULES

The office is your space that you spend much of your waking hours in. It's not just your workplace, it is a place where we interact with our colleagues & mentors. It is also a space for us to share new ideas, problems and find solutions or resolve them. It is where we build a bond of trust and confidence that helps us become a better team in times to come. Respect it. Keeping it clean and hygienic while also adding good cheer to the space is a responsibility that we need not remind everyone.

3.1 ATTENDANCE.

Attendance is a standard measure of job performance. Punctuality and regular attendance is expected of all employees. Employees with excessive unexcused absences or repeated tardiness may be subject to a negative performance review or termination of employment.

Attendance will be discussed at performance reviews in an attempt to measure an employee's commitment to position, and to determine if they are well suited for the position they hold.

All absences must be reported to the Human Resources Manager and the Department Manager. When reporting an absence, please specify the nature of the absence and whether vacation days, paid time off (PTO) or compensatory leaves will be used. PHXINDIA LLP does not pay for time spent on personal business or extended breaks.

Altering, falsifying, tampering with attendance records, or proxy attendance on another employee's record will result in disciplinary action, including termination of employment.

3.2 OFFICE TIMING

For the office staff, the workweek begins on Monday and ends on Saturday with Sunday being a weekly off. The standard office timing is from 10:00 AM to 6:30 PM, with a half hour lunch break between 1:00 PM to 1:30 PM. You also have two 10 min tea/ coffee breaks anytime daily.

Note : Although we would not be concerned with when you take your lunch break, it is clear that the time allocated to it is not more than 30 mins. We do not have restrictions with you having tea/ coffee or light beverages during the working hours as long as you are not repeatedly using these techniques to stall work or be unavailable to do work. Changes in these guidelines is possible and will be authorised by the admin and the current office rules guidelines will be in force.

3.3 PROFESSIONAL STAFF

It is clear that on days of assignments the crew will report as per the reporting time shared by their Team Leaders. They shall complete the assignment as required and if it is a full-day assignment, they can return to their place of residence directly from the site. But if they are assigned the responsibility of returning the equipment to the office, they will do so before returning home. On days of half day assignments depending on the time schedule, they can be asked to come to office in case there is work.

On days when there are no assignments they follow the same rules as the support staff. Only on the day-after-the-shoot, they are allowed to report to work late (but not later than 12:00 Noon) if the shoot ends post 9:00 PM or has taken more than 9 hours which ever is earlier. While on outstation assignments, in case they arrive in Mumbai later than 1:30 AM that morning, they are allowed to come whenever they can to complete their responsibilities as laid out in their specific Team SOP documents. To put it more explicitly, the Firm only expects the technical staff to ensure the post production standard operating procedures are adhered to and the job is on track as expected. Please note, professional and technical staff can be asked to report to office by the Team Leaders, admin or management at any time. When in doubt, follow the standard office timings as mentioned in 3.2.

3.4 CODE OF ETHICS AND CODE OF CONDUCT.

Standards of ethics and conduct for PHXINDIA LLP are important, and the Firm takes them seriously. Employees are expected to follow codes and standards in conducting the Firm's business and doing their jobs.

Deviating from Firm rules and standards can lead to disciplinary action, including termination of employment (all employees, see section VI and VII; professional staff, see section VIII of Firm Handbook).

The General Code Of Conduct is applicable to all employees, associates, professionals etc.

The Professional Code Of Conduct is more specifically directed to Professionals

4. GENERAL CODE OF CONDUCT

Our General Code of Conduct outlines our expectations regarding employees behaviour towards their colleagues, supervisors and overall organisation.

We promote freedom of expression and open communication. We also expect them to foster a well-organised, respectful and collaborative environment. Firm employees are bound by their contract to follow our Code of Conduct while performing their duties. We outline the components of our Code of Conduct below: Here are some pointers...

1. **Mind your language!** What you say and how you say it either wins hearts or breaks them. Take it seriously and learn if you don't know how.
2. **Introduce yourself** to a new client or people you meet. Be polite and courteous.
3. **Behave like a professional** at all times. Always remember **you are on a JOB** and not invited to chill or critique anyone's work.
4. Don't be **constantly on the phone**. Neither the client nor the firm is paying for that.
5. We won't all agree all the time, but **disagreement is no excuse for disrespectful behaviour**. We will all experience frustration from time to time, but we cannot allow that frustration become personal attacks. An environment where people feel uncomfortable or threatened is not a productive or creative one.
6. In case of any problems or disputes with team members, **talk to your Team Leader/ or talk to admin**. Step aside or ask for a time for later when you can express your point of view (or disbelief). You can do that confidentially as well. Never discuss any workplace or personal problems in front of the clients.
7. **Do not promise anything to the client without clarity**. Always offer to get back to them and then connect with your seniors before making the commitment. Once made, ensure that it is done.
8. **Do not pickup anyone's stuff from anywhere**, whether it's an office or a home. It can be small but the owner's perception of you can be damaging. Simple things like charger cables, etc. should be used after taking permission from the owners.
9. **Anyone working in PHXINDIA can be asked to go on duty with any division for work** (PHX | MGX | SFX). We always try to orient your interests with the work you do, but in case of need, you will comply.
10. **You should not back out from your shoot commitments**. Or another commitment you made the clients or your team. Reflects on your character and reliability. In a team work scenarios, we expect everyone to be doing their bit.
11. **We strictly prohibit the sale, possession, distribution or use of illegal substances** and items, and the misuse of prescription medications in our workplaces.

12. **Being under the influence of alcohol or other substances is prohibited** in the workplace or at work-related events, or anywhere that your conduct may affect the reputation of the Firm or safety and well-being of our people. It is a violation to work while under the influence of drugs, alcohol or other substances that impair your ability to work safely and effectively..
13. **Violence, verbal abuse and acts that include breaking the law**, even when you are not on the job **can become grounds of concern** and can be used against you during appraisals.
14. The office is “your” workplace and you spend a large amount of time there. An efficient office can help you perform better at your task. **Ensure that the workplace is a happy, clean and hygienic place**. Every once in a while contributing to its upkeep and helping to maintain the office is something that will be appreciated and recorded.
15. In the workplace, **treat each other with respect, and value the contributions of every member of your team**. We know that we can only be successful if we create an inclusive, fair and positive working environment. We won't allow any kind of discriminatory behaviour, harassment or victimisation.
16. Obey the law. PHXINDIA LLP takes its responsibilities to comply with laws and regulations very seriously and each of us is expected to comply with applicable legal requirements and prohibitions.
17. **Employees should be friendly and collaborative**. They should try not to disrupt the workplace or present obstacles to their colleagues' work.
18. **We expect employees to not abuse their employment benefits**. This can refer to time off, pantry facilities, subscriptions or other benefits our Firm offers or may offer from time to time.

5. PROFESSIONAL CODE OF CONDUCT

While on assignment, we put forward our very best and maintain the protocol that is already in place for all assignments. Refer to Standard operating procedures (SOP) document. This list of guidelines for each team that works on assignments which will be made available by their respective Team Leader. The Team Leader (Photographer, Producer, Stylist, etc, as the case may be) takes the final call in all matters related to the assignment and you will act in accordance with those decisions. Post the assignment timings, you are free to be who you want to be but please keeping in mind the points discussed in **General Code of Conduct**.

1) DRESSING AND CLOTHING

Smart casuals or semi formals are acceptable dressing while on duty. Do not wear clothes that might offend the clients or the home-owners sensibility where you are on assignments. Your style statement does not get us more assignments, but your smartness and decency does.

2) PUNCTUALITY

Always arrive before reporting time. The time mentioned on the call sheet might be the time to start the shoot. You have to account for travel time. As a rule, PHXINDIA does not like to be late!

3) TRAVELLING CODE

3)a. #onassignment within hometown

- i. Always arrive before reporting time to account last minute cross checking and packing time.
- ii. Keep some extra cash with you and also activate your Uber or Ola account just in case the planned conveyance plan has to be altered or changed for whatever reason.

3)b. #onassignment outstation

- i. Travel light and carry only what is needed. Double check what is needed three times if you have to with your Team Leader.
- ii. The **equipment is high priority at all times** and your personal belongings are an add-on. So do not carry anything expensive that can be avoided. Equipment is taken as cabin baggage and personal belongings will be checked-in or moved with other luggage.
- iii. **Keep clothes simple** and neutral and comfortable. Preferable stuff that is quick dry and does not require too much care.
- iv. **Carry just enough clothes.** You are going on an assignment and not dating. Your style statement does not get us more assignments, but your smartness and decency does.

- v. **Always carry your travel kit** which includes your chargers and your toiletries. (toothbrush paste, etc.) Always keep a set packed and ready to leave.
- vi. Wear footwear that is comfortable and simple and can last the entire schedule. Remember that on assignment you have to shoot mostly without any footwear when you are shooting interiors. So **we recommend that you wear slippers or sandals** that work best in such circumstances.
- vii. Outstation assignments of long durations might tempt you to add some personal agenda and short trips to the schedule. While the Firm is not against it, the expenses incurred are personal. **You have to ensure that you are well rested and available for the job** as per the schedule and requirement of the assignment. If your actions lead to problems on site and in the assignment, the Firm will recover any losses occurring thereof and also take disciplinary action against you.

4) EQUIPMENT CARE

- a. Handle the equipment with care. **The equipment you are entrusted with is your responsibility.** Using it appropriately and safe-guarding it is a part of your duty and there will be no excuses entertained if items are damaged or lost while in your care. The Firm can move to recover the losses from your earnings. If a team is entrusted the responsibility, it remains their collective responsibility to take care of the equipment.
- b. It is advisable to keep your equipment gear cleaned and charged on the previous day. **Do not keep anything for the last minute.** Having uncharged batteries and missing gear is something that score high negative points for you. Divide the responsibility so that each team member can contribute effectively!! Always keep your Camera Kit and your belongings together in a safe place.

5) INTERACTION WITH TEAM

- a. Always be respectful and courteous to your team members.
- b. The Team Leader or Shoot-in-Charge will lead the shoot and you will follow the instructions of the Team Leader. In case you have a doubt or any disagreement, you will talk to the Team Leader privately and explain your point of view or request the team to find a place where you can discuss and explain your point of view.
- c. Please keep your personal problems outside the shoot.
- d. While on the job, support your team or assist other colleagues wholeheartedly.
- e. **Stay with the team and the equipments.** Do not wander around during shoots. Wandering into others personal spaces or areas they consider as private, can embarrass or offend the client and lead to consequences which we are not willing to explore.

- f. Do not engage in any sort of arguments with your colleagues or the Team Leader in front of the clients.
- g. It is best to take your Team Leader and colleagues into confidence before doing anything on site.
- h. Know your role and responsibilities and fulfil it.

6) INTERACTION WITH YOUR CLIENT

- a. Introduce yourself to the client and his team.
- b. Do not interrupt discussions between the Shoot-in-Charge and the client.
- c. Always remember you are there on a JOB and not to critique anyone's work.
- d. If the client asks you anything that you are not sure about, direct them to the Team Leader or tell them you will get back to them. Do not give false answers or make any commitments on behalf of the team or Firm.
- e. Never get into any argument with the client/ architect/ owners/ others unless your Team Leader or senior on site lets you or winks at you.
- f. No commenting on the design or work of the client while on the site. They are not paying for your opinion. Not yet. If they ask you a question, answer diplomatically and courteously.

7) COMMITMENT

- a. Saying yes to an assignment is a commitment that sets into motion the planning and co-ordination between the client, the site owners and a whole lot of professionals, vendors and staff.
- b. Cancelling a booked assignment is thoroughly unprofessional and will never be done unless the circumstances are beyond our control.
- c. It is best to think before making the commitment but once made, treat it like a sacred contract. Never treat it lightly because our reputation is at stake.
- d. It is best to give your non-available dates to the admin/CRM much in advance before the shoot dates are offered to the clients.

8) COPYRIGHTS

- a. Every project, design and site that you see or shoot has copyrights of either the designer, owner, artist or creator. Learn to respect that and do not go about taking pictures without seeking permission.
- b. **Usage of assignment or job related images on personal pages and social media is a case of copyright violation and strictly prohibited..**
- c. Always take a clearance from admin before you make any site-related uploads anywhere. Please also see our **Digital Code of Ethics (13.6)** for further guidance.
- d. For whatever reason, if the firm orders you to remove certain images already uploaded, you will do so without questioning and with immediate effect.

6. WAGE AND SALARY POLICIES

6.1 WAGE OR SALARY.

All employees are paid monthly. The payment is usually processed before the 10th of the following month. Most payments are made directly to the employees bank account. Standard deductions will apply based on income tax laws, state laws and Firm policies. You can get a detailed break up of your remuneration/ salary from the accounts department. Your payslip recording your monthly salary will be emailed to you every month.

Our salary or remuneration packages are based on many factors and primarily on merit and therefore will vary from employee to employee. For those entitled for Commissions and bonuses, these will be paid quarterly or half yearly or as decided by the management. Employee Benefits and reward payouts etc are paid yearly. Employee wages are reviewed yearly typically around the close of the financial year but will depend on market conditions and also performance reviews.

6.2 OVERTIME OR PAID TIME OFF.

We do not have a standard overtime policy but it is treated on a case to case basis. For extra hours put in by Support staff or professionals off duty, owing to extra work and demands by the management, paid time offs (PTO) will be given to set-off the overtime. In case the employee has failed to deliver their job as per the time schedule and have to put in extra hours to ensure that their commitment is met, no overtime or paid time off allowances are made.

Crew or professional staff have no time limits when on an assignment. We are conscious and value the work put in by the employee, individual or team and will reward such commitment and sincerity in more ways than one. In cash, kind or benefits will be the managements decision

6.3 BENEFITS AND SERVICES.

PHXINDIA LLP is currently offering leave benefits for its confirmed employees and is contemplating many other benefits program for its employees & associates. Offers such as Life Insurance and Health insurance, long term service rewards and other benefits designed exclusively for those employed with us. We will in the due course of time share the details and the required time necessary to qualify for the benefits included in and administered through these programs.

7. HOLIDAYS

There is one day off for every week which is your right and mandatory as per law. For practical reasons, we shall consider Sunday as the weekly day off. The Professional staff do not have a specific day as holiday owing to the nature of their work but can avail of the day off by following the simple guidelines mentioned herein.

In a year, **12 official holidays** will be observed in PHXINDIA LLP. A list of holidays will be circulated at the beginning of the year. Adding to this an employee is entitled to avail **2 days of restricted holidays** that can be used during their relevant festivals. The same will be intimated to the department head and HR so that the holidays are marked accordingly. Choose wisely.

No employee shall be allowed to avail any leave during notice/probation period. Any leave or absence during notice period shall be considered as shortfall in notice and be liable to forfeit salary by no. of days equivalent to shortfall.

The Firm reserves the right to amend/modify/alter or even cancel in part, in entirety any of the leave privileges offered herein. The same will be intimated to the employees by email or a notice from time to time.

8. LEAVE POLICY

It is to be understood that a leave is a privilege offered by the Firm and not a matter of right. A holiday in a week and national holidays are rights, which will be compensated or adjusted in case the employee has to report to work due to unavoidable reasons. Following the procedure will assure you of no-loss in pay for the paid leaves that the Firm allows you to take in a calendar year. Please read this document carefully and clarify your doubts if any.

8.1 UNPLANNED LEAVE

- Employee is requested to avoid taking unplanned leave. This is not welcome and can attract penalty or disciplinary action if not checked.
- If employee is taking unplanned leave due to unavoidable circumstances, they are advised to call the reporting Manager/Supervisor and inform him of his inability to attend to work.
- Employee who is on leave without informing his Manager/Supervisor for more than three days should meet the respective heads and HR and submit a written note stating reason for absenteeism without informing, before resuming duty. These days will attract loss of pay and also cancellation of earned leaves. The decision taken by the HR and departmental head in this matter is final and abiding.

8.2 COMPENSATORY HOLIDAY

If you are working on a declared holiday or your weekly holiday, you have the right to take a compensatory off on any day when there is no work pressure. You have to plan your compensatory off day in advance after discussion with your team head so that all are aware of your absence that day. If you are clubbing your weekly off and compensatory off, you must get the approval of the team head.

The compensatory leave must be taken within four weeks from the day, failing which they will be deemed as lapsed. Under extraordinary circumstances, where shortage of manpower or other unavoidable reasons are in existence, the leave can be taken at the next available time period.

9. PAID LEAVES

The following set of leave privileges are applicable to staff who have completed 180 of service from their date of confirmation in the Firm. Privilege leaves are for those who finish 1 year of continuous employment in the firm.

9.1 PERIOD OF LEAVE CALCULATION

The holiday year in the Firm runs from 1st January to 31st December. If you are in the service of the Firm you are entitled for paid leave as follows.

- **6 days of Casual Leave,**
- **6 days of Sick Leave and**
- **10 days of Privilege Leave** (4 days of Earned Leave (EL) and maximum 6 Special Earned Leave (SEL)) **

On Probation and contract the employee is not eligible for leave benefits during probation. If an employee takes leave during the probation period, it will be treated as leave without pay (LWP).

9.2 CASUAL LEAVE (CL)

- Maximum 6 leaves in a calendar year.
- Need to apply for a casual leave with Admin dept after approval from Team Head. Notice of casual leave application must reach HR department 7 days in advance, and the employee should get it approved before proceeding on leave.
- Available only if approved by HR.
- If casual leaves are not taken in a calendar year, they are lapsed..
- Casual leave can be taken with approval from the respective Department Heads.

- Casual leave can be availed in the form of Half days. Not more than 2 days of casual leave will be sanctioned unless the employee has accrued enough leaves that might not be used up in the remaining months.

9.3 SICK LEAVE (SL)

- Maximum 6 leaves in a calendar year.
- Sick leaves are approved by HR and If the employee is unable to attend his/her duties for three continuous days or longer, he/she will be required to produce a registered Medical Practitioner's leave & fitness certificate on his/her return to duties.
- Sick leave can also be half days if the employee falls ill suddenly while at work. The department head will have to grant the approval for the same.

9.4 SPECIAL SICK LEAVE (SSL)

- Unused sick leave up will be carried forward to the next year and be considered as Special Sick Leave. Not more than 30 days of un-availed sick leave can be carried forward.
- Special sick leave can be availed if the sick leave is exhausted and this is recommended for major sickness.
- Employees availing three consecutive days of special sick leave will need to submit the Medical Certificate.

9.5 EARNED LEAVE (EL)

- Maximum 4 leaves in a calendar year. Earned leave cannot be granted in units of half day
- As an incentive against taking unwanted leaves, the Firm shall credit one day Earned leave for those employees who have been in service for more than 1 year at that time and have not taken any leave in the preceding quarter. The quarter ends in March, June, Sep, and Dec.
- Earned leaves are a part of the Privilege Leave. Earned leave is carried forward and can be used anytime during your employment with the Firm..
- Available only if approved by HR.

9.6 SPECIAL EARNED LEAVE (SEL)

- Maximum 6 leaves in a calendar year.
- From time to time, the Firm rewards high performance employees with leave days for their contribution to the Firms growth and success and also for their dedication and sincerity during the working days. The decision of the management is final and abiding in this regard.
- Earned leaves are a part of the Privilege Leave. Earned leave is carried forward and can be used anytime during your employment with the Firm..

9.7 MATERNITY AND PATERNITY LEAVE

The Firm believes that the personal obligations of employees who become parents should be respected and grants leave to eligible employees for the birth and care of a first newborn biological child.

A. MATERNITY LEAVE

- A.1. only full time confirmed female employees are eligible for paid maternity leave.
- A.2. It is granted as a continuous period of 6 weeks from the date of commencement of the leave.
- A.3. Full pay (Basic Salary) will be made for a period of upto 30 Days for absence due to maternity. Additional leave for 45 days (6 weeks) with no pay might be granted if requested in advance.
- A.4. Employee is requested to submit a request for maternity leave at least two months before taking leave.
- A.5. Employee is requested to submit the medical certificate and the necessary documents upon joining.
- A.6. The employee's employment at the Firm is guaranteed for a period of 4 months from the time of proceeding on leave. If the Firm is not informed and approvals not taken / or granted, the Firm will have to find a replacement to ensure that work and business is not affected.

B. PATERNITY LEAVE

- B.1. Only full-time confirmed male employees are eligible for paid Paternity leave.
- B.2. For the biological father taking Paternity Leave, up to 6 days of leave is provided for the purpose of providing care for his newborn child.
- B.3. This leave is requested to be availed within 3 months of baby's birth and can be availed in splits.

PLEASE NOTE: The above-mentioned rules (9.7 - A & B), are applicable in case of firstborns only.

9.8 LEAVE FOR ADOPTIVE CHILD CARE

The Firm believes that for a country as populous as India, acts such as adoption are the need of the hour. As a mark of recognition, appreciation and respect, the Firm is happy to extend the following privilege to full-time employees who intend to be adoptive parents upon submission of documents pertaining to the adoption and its approval by an accredited agency. If the adopted child is below 1 year of age, the following rules apply.

C. MATERNITY LEAVE

- C.1. Full pay will be made for a period of up to 30 days for absence to provide maternity care. Additional leave for 30 days (4 weeks) with half pay can be granted if requested in advance. Extended leaves are possible at no pay subject to sanction and authorisation from HR / Management.
- C.2. Employee is requested to submit a request for maternity leave at least two months before taking leave.
- C.3. The employee's employment at the Firm is guaranteed for a period of 4 months from the time of proceeding on leave. If the Firm is not informed and approvals not taken/ or granted, the Firm will have to find a replacement to ensure that work and business is not affected.

D. PATERNITY LEAVE

- D.1. For the adoptive father taking Paternity Leave, up to 15 days of leave is provided for the purpose of providing care for the child.
- D.2. This leave is requested to be availed within 6 months of the adoption and can be availed in splits.

For those adopting children over 1 year of age. A special leave of upto 3 weeks with pay will be granted for mothers and 1 week with pay for fathers.

9.9 LEAVE ENCASHMENT

Un-availed earned leave & Special Earned Leaves at the end of your service will be paid based on the basic salary last drawn not exceeding to a total of 60 days of privilege leaves. This is included as part of your salary pay-out when encashed.

9.10 CALCULATING EXTENDED LEAVES

Any non-working day/days (national holidays/festival holidays/weekends) falling during the period of leave (excluding the prefix and suffix) will be treated as part of the leave. For example,

- If you take leave from Thursday to the following Wednesday, this is regarded as seven days of absence.
- Similarly, if you take leave from Monday, and resume the following Monday, this is regarded as six days of leave as the suffix (Sunday) is excluded from the count. However, if you are availing leave from Monday and resume work on the following Tuesday, this is regarded as eight days of leave as the Sunday that falls within your leave period will be counted as part of the leave.
- Seek clarity with admin before proceeding for the leave.

9.11 LEAVE WITHOUT PAY

- Leave without pay is granted only in exceptional circumstances approved by the Department Head and only after all annual leave entitlement has been used up.
- Weekends and national holidays in between the leave are included in the calculation of number of days of absence as LWP.

10. AVAILING LEAVE

PHXINDIA LLP follows the policy of “Earn and Avail”. If your joining date is in the middle of the year, then you will be eligible for proportionate casual and earned leave.

Half of the total days of Earned, Sick, Casual leave will be credited to each employee every half yearly. Employees can accumulate and avail of the leave.

Employees joining or receiving confirmations in between the quarters will not be eligible to get one day of credit for the respective quarter.

GENERAL PROCEDURE FOR AVAILING LEAVE

1. Leave applications will only be considered once the employee is confirmed and has completed 6 months of continuous service.
2. The employee is required to give prior notice to the Divisional Heads before taking leave (two weeks notice for Privilege Leaves and a week before Casual Leave).
3. Employees must submit to their Team Leader, a “**Leave Application Form**” indicating reasons for and duration of absence prior to proceeding for leave.
4. The supervisor/manager must approve all leave prior to taking the leave.
5. The employee is then required to submit the approved ‘**Leave Application Form**’ with the HR Department.
6. Leave approvals will be based on operational requirements, merit, reasonableness and past practice. Leave may get cancelled owing to work pressure.
7. On approval from the HR department the leave will be granted.
8. Leave for ‘Department Heads’ are to be approved by the Management and further notified to the HR Department.
9. The employee must ensure that their leave application (except sick leave) has been approved before commencing on leave. Failure to do so will result in Loss of Pay.
10. In case of absence because of sickness leave application to be submitted immediately on the day of resumption of duty.
11. In case employees need extension of leave, they must call and take approval from the Departmental Heads who will then forward the request to HR. In case the request is not accepted, or rejected, the employee is expected to join duty on schedule. The decision of HR will be final and abiding in these matters.

11. ADMINISTRATION & ACCOUNTING

11.1 REIMBURSEMENTS

EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT.

Legitimate expenses which are carried out during the course of ones duty is receivable from the firm in the form of reimbursements. It is important to note that many of these expenses (incurred on assignment) are billable to the clients. Also as per taxation laws there are certain guidelines (e.g. the bill has to be in the company name with GST number etc.) and limits to such expenses beyond which it can become taxable or disallowed. It is better to take authorisation before making any such expenses on the firms behalf.

- Reimbursements are subject to submission of vouchers only.
- Timely submissions of vouchers, expense statements or credit card statements etc with supporting documents is essential for your reimbursements to be cleared.
- Reimbursements will be made within 7 days of the submission of your voucher with supporting documents.
- Authorisation of Team Leader or Admin might be required in some case for the reimbursement to be initiated.

11.2 VOUCHER SUBMISSION (EXPENSE REPORTING)

- a) Vouchers are to be submitted weekly and are also settled weekly. The admin & accounts (A&A) dept will issue directives from time to time as to the date of submission of vouchers and the date of payment.
- b) All vouchers are to be attached with a supporting document (valid bill) for the process to be smooth.
- c) In case you do not have any bill or supporting document, chances are that the voucher might not be cleared by A&A. You will need special authorisation of the partners for such expenses.
- d) You are advices to make your purchases from places that give you a valid bill.
- e) For purchases that are above a certain amount (as decided by A & A from time to time) you must have the authorisation of the departmental head or the accounts in charge to process that payment.

- f) For expenses that are high on GST value, you are advised to make the invoice only in the name of the Firm and ensure that the GST number of the Firm is printed on the bill.
- g) Follow the “Voucher Submission and payment” instructions issued by the Accounts and Admin department in this regard.

11.3 BUSINESS RECORDS

Accurate record-keeping and reporting of financial and non-financial information reflect on our firm’s reputation and are an important part of our legal and regulatory obligations as a firm. They are the cornerstone of our business Integrity which is one of our core values. Accurate record-keeping and reporting are also necessary to assess individual performance and assess compensation for all employees fairly, based on merit and actual results.

The term “business record” is interpreted broadly. Every business related document, even an apparently insignificant one, must be complete and accurate.

Always make sure that you record and document business transactions properly and correctly, namely: in the right time period, with the right amount, authorised internally by the appropriate persons, and describing the true nature of the transaction.

11.4 FIRM SUPPLIES AND EXPENDITURES.

Employees whose regular duties do not include purchasing shall not make purchases behalf of PHXINDIA LLP without written approval. In order to make purchases in the name of the Firm, you must be authorised by ADMIN or THE PARTNERS.

11.6 RECORDING TRANSACTIONS

If your job involves the financial recording of our transactions, make sure that you’re fully familiar with all of the PHXINDIA LLP policies that apply.

Immediately report to the Partners, any transactions that you think are not being recorded correctly.

A. REPORTING FINANCIAL IRREGULARITIES

It goes without saying (but we’re going to say it anyway) that you should never, ever interfere in any way with the auditing of PHXINDIA LLP’s financial records. Similarly, you should never falsify any record or account, including time reports, expense accounts, and any other PHXINDIA LLP records.

If you suspect or observe any of the conduct mentioned above or, for that matter, any irregularities relating to financial integrity or fiscal responsibility, no matter how small, immediately report them to the admin or Partners.

B. RETAINING RECORDS

It’s important that we keep records for an appropriate length of time as mandated by the Law. The CA or Financial Consultants suggests minimum

record retention periods for certain types of records. In addition, if asked by Partners or their advisors to retain records relevant to a litigation, audit, or investigation, do so until Legal tells you retention is no longer necessary.

C. HIRING SUPPLIERS

As PHXINDIA LLP grows, we enter into more and more deals with suppliers of equipment and services. We should always strive for the best possible deal for PHXINDIA LLP. This almost always requires that you solicit competing bids to make sure that you're getting the best offer. While price is very important, it isn't the only factor worth considering. Quality, service, reliability, and the terms and conditions of the proposed deal may also affect the final decision. Please do not hesitate to contact the Partners if you have any questions regarding how to procure equipment or services.

11.7 SIGNING A CONTRACT

- I. Each time you enter into a business transaction on PHXINDIA LLP's behalf, there should be documentation recording that agreement, approved by the Partners or their Legal Aides. Signing a contract on behalf of PHXINDIA LLP is a very big deal. Never sign any contract on behalf of PHXINDIA LLP unless all of the following are met:
- II. You are authorised to do so under guidance from the partners. If you are unsure whether you are authorised, ask!
- III. The contract has been approved by Legal. If you are using an approved PHXINDIA LLP form contract, you don't need further Legal approval unless you have made changes to the form contract or are using it for other than its intended purpose
- IV. You have studied the contract, understood its terms and decided that entering into the contract is in PHXINDIA LLP's interest
- V. All contracts at PHXINDIA LLP should be in writing and should contain all of the relevant terms to which the parties are agreeing – PHXINDIA LLP does not permit "side agreements," oral or written.

12. CONFLICT OF INTEREST

We are a meritocracy. Excellence is one of our core values. Conflicts of interest impair our ability to act with excellence. A conflict of interest arises when your personal activities, interests or relationships interfere, or appear to interfere, with your professional duties as an associate or employee of PHXINDIA LLP or your ability to act in the best interest of PHXINDIA LLP. Even in circumstances where you do not receive personal benefit, the appearance of a conflict of interest may negatively impact your credibility.

You must proactively notify, the Admin any relationships or interests that could conflict or appear to conflict with the performance of your duties for the Firm. All notifications are treated confidentially.

It is not possible to define all situations or relationships which may create a conflict of interest, so each situation must be evaluated individually. Some specific conflict-of-interest situations and examples are set out below. Always keep in mind that in most cases conflicts can be resolved by open discussion and transparency. A conflict of interest is not necessarily a Code violation, but not disclosing it is.

12.1. DEALING WITH PEOPLE

A POTENTIAL CUSTOMER, CUSTOMER, SUPPLIER OR PUBLIC OFFICIAL

A conflict of interest arises if you make a business decision motivated by personal interest in a potential customer, customer, supplier or public official; or when you receive a personal benefit from one of our potential customers, or suppliers, or a public official. If a relative or someone with whom you have a close personal relationship is involved in a PHXINDIA LLP-related business decision of yours, this might lead to a conflict of interest. In such cases, it is your responsibility to make sure that the conflict of interest is resolved. This will involve communicating the situation promptly to ADMIN.

Example: You are involved in finding a new supplier. Your cousin brother works at one of the suppliers. Communicate the issue internally and stop participating in the tendering process. Make sure that you do not receive any sensitive information and that you are excluded from the decision-making process.

12.2. OUTSIDE INVESTMENTS

Refrain from investments that could affect your decision-making on behalf of PHXINDIA LLP, including investments in customers, competitors or suppliers of PHXINDIA LLP (except regarding shares in publicly traded companies, which may be held for personal investment purposes). If you plan to make an investment that might appear to affect your decision-making on behalf of PHXINDIA LLP, seek approval from the ADMIN.

12.3. OUTSIDE EMPLOYMENT

- If you would like to take outside employment on your own time that could potentially result in a conflict of interest, you must receive prior approval.
- If the work is connected to our business in any way (e.g. dealing with PHXINDIA LLP's existing customers or potential customers, suppliers, etc.) or is in the same line of activity as PHXINDIA thereby creating a competition or price variation, you are not allowed to do it.

- If it takes so much of your time and energy that your work for PHXINDIA LLP could be affected is a conflict of interest.
- Outside employment that could influence your judgement in a way that could harm PHXINDIA LLP's interests will not be approved.
- Even if outside employment is approved, always make sure that you do not share any non-public information about PHXINDIA LLP.
- These rules apply to all forms of employment, including full-time and part-time positions, self-employment, consultancy or one-time arrangements such as speeches or presentations. No approval is required to serve on charity boards.

Example: You cannot act as a director, officer, agent or consultant for one of our suppliers. If you are a cameraman, you cannot work at another film production house at the weekend.

12.4. POLITICAL ACTIVITY

We encourage personal participation in civil society and in the political process. However, your job must not be affected by your personal political views or activity. If you plan to seek or accept a public office, you must obtain prior approval.

12.5. FAMILY OR CLOSE PERSONAL RELATIONSHIPS

While we recognise that colleagues may have or form family or close personal relationships with other colleagues, we also have a strong commitment to merit and equal opportunity. Therefore, to ensure objective, fair and equal treatment among employees, we do not allow relatives or people with close personal relationships to report directly or ultimately to each other.

There can be conflicts of interest even if related employees work in different departments, due to the nature of their duties, especially where one of the employees will be auditing, approving or reviewing the work of the other.

Avoiding potential conflicts of interest also means that you should not use PHXINDIA LLP products, services, internal tools, or information in a way that improperly benefits you or someone you know or creates the appearance that you have an unfair advantage over users outside of PHXINDIA LLP.

13. USE OF FIRM'S ASSETS

13.1 INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

PHXINDIA LLP's intellectual property rights (our trademarks, logos, copyrights, trade secrets, "know-how", and patents) are among our most valuable assets.

- All assignments done on behalf of PHXINDIA LLP is copyright protected by the firm and is owned by the firm and is an asset. Every person who has been

credited as its creator is assigned the moral right as a creator to use the pictures as a part of the personal portfolio with credits to phxindia and also the client and any other copyrights holder associated with the image in the prescribed format. They must however refrain from using the images in any public platform without the permission from the the Firm (Copyrights holder).

- Unauthorised use can lead to their loss or serious loss of value. You must respect all copyright and other intellectual property laws, including laws governing the fair use of copyrights, trademarks, and brands.
- You must never use PHXINDIA LLP's (or its affiliated entities') logos, marks, or other protected information or property for any business or commercial venture without pre-clearance from the Admin.
- Employee time and intellectual property (*anything that we create on PHXINDIA LLP time, at PHXINDIA LLP's expense or within the scope of our duties - while on assignment*) is also protected as assets and must be used in the best way possible for the organisation.
- We strongly encourage you to report any suspected misuse of trademarks, logos, or other PHXINDIA LLP intellectual property to Legal.
- Likewise, respect the intellectual property rights of others. Inappropriate use of others' intellectual property may expose PHXINDIA LLP and you to criminal and civil fines and penalties.
- Please seek advice from the Partners before you solicit, accept, or use proprietary information from individuals outside the Firm or let them use or have access to PHXINDIA LLP proprietary information.
- PHXINDIA LLP relies widely on its business data and information systems to achieve its business objectives. We are each responsible for ensuring that we always do business in a secure way, limiting risks of any leakage or loss of business data and of any damage to or misuse of our information systems.
- We should be particularly careful in protecting the Firm's confidential business data that refers to any information that the Firm has not disclosed or made generally available to the public and that, if disclosed, could harm the interests of PHXINDIA LLP.

13.2 FIRM EQUIPMENT

PHXINDIA LLP gives us the tools and equipment we need to do our jobs effectively, but counts on us to be responsible and not wasteful with the PHXINDIA LLP stuff we are given. PHXINDIA LLP assets are there to conduct its business and are provided to you to do your job in the most efficient way. Not sure if a certain use of Firm assets is okay? Please ask your Team Leader.

We are generally not allowed to use PHXINDIA LLP assets for personal purposes and benefit. Limited personal use of mobile devices, laptops and tablets within reason is permitted, but our use should be lawful, appropriate and never interfere with our time at work. Theft of Firms assets, irrespective of value, is a serious breach of this Code.

Any exceptions must be approved in the ADMIN. Exceptions can never be given for the use of PHXINDIA LLP assets for an outside business or other personal gain, or for anything illegal or unethical.

13.3 SHARED KNOWLEDGE

Our shared understanding, expertise, practical and market-related knowledge is more powerful than our individual knowledge. Clients expect us to bring this collective know-how to everything we do. And doing so ensures that we will be perceived as the premier Firm we aspire to be.

The know-how produced while working for the Firm is a Firm asset. Every professional, technician and support staff is expected to share their know-how, directly upon request for advice or assistance, or indirectly by using Firm knowledge management systems and processes. Our professionals also are expected to call on the knowledge of others when issues are beyond their experience, knowledge or jurisdiction, and to use shared know-how responsibly.

13.4 CONFIDENTIAL INFORMATION

Proposals, charges and fees, discounts offered, camera settings, Processing settings and hire/ purchase rates etc are some examples of the information that is business oriented and related to the Firms operations. Information about the Partners or any colleagues assets, persona details and other information that may be deemed sensitive are also taken into the broad spectrum of classified information. At times, a particular project or negotiation may require you to disclose Need to Know or Confidential information to an outside party: Disclosure of that information should be on an “only as needed” basis and only under a non-disclosure agreement. In addition, PHXINDIA LLP policy may require a prior security assessment of the outside party that is to receive the confidential information. Be sure to conduct the appropriate due diligence and have the appropriate agreement in place before you disclose the information.

There are, of course, “grey areas” in which you will need to apply your best judgment in making sure you don’t disclose any confidential information. Suppose a friend who works as a photographer asks you informally how to take pictures of landscapes: Giving your friend basic tips that available in public articles and on websites isn’t likely to be a problem, but giving tips that aren’t publicly known, specifically the way our Firm does it, definitely would be. If you’re in a grey area, be cautious in what advice or insight you provide or, better yet, ask for guidance from the Partners.

And don’t forget about pictures you and your guests take at PHXINDIA LLP – it is up to you to be sure that those pictures don’t disclose confidential information.

Finally, some of us will find ourselves having family or other personal relationships with people employed by our competitors or business partners. As in most cases, common sense applies. Don’t tell your significant other or family members anything confidential, and don’t solicit confidential information from them about their Firm.

Just as you are careful not to disclose confidential PHXINDIA LLP information, it's equally important not to disclose any confidential information from our partners. Don't accept confidential information from other companies without first having all parties sign an appropriate Non-disclosure Agreement approved by Legal. Even after the agreement is signed, try only to accept as much information as you need to accomplish your business objectives.

13.5. INFORMATION PROTECTION POLICY (IPP)

Anything you do using PHXINDIA LLP's corporate electronic facilities (e.g., our computers, mobile devices, network, etc.) or store on our premises (e.g., letters, memos, and other documents) might be disclosed to people inside and outside the Firm. For example, PHXINDIA LLP may be required by law (e.g., in response to a subpoena or warrant) to monitor, access, and disclose the contents of corporate email, voicemail, computer files, and other materials on our electronic facilities or on our premises. In addition, the Firm may monitor, access, and disclose employee communications and other information on our corporate electronic facilities or on our premises where there is a business need to do so, such as protecting employees and users, maintaining the security of resources and property, or investigating suspected employee misconduct. You should have no expectations of privacy when using the Firm's technology. Anything you write, save, transmit or record to Firm technologies may be viewed by the Firm, without your advance permission, except where such review is specifically prohibited by local law.

Our IPP makes sure that our business data and information systems are protected from a wide range of threats and events that could have a negative impact on the confidentiality, availability and integrity of our business data and information systems. Please refer to the IPP for all regulatory documents in the area of information security – for example standards, procedures, rules and guidelines – which are based on, or aligned with, the IPP.

Example of a violations:

To leave a computer password with a co-worker to handle any requests or provide approvals on the various Firm systems when you are on leave. Inform admin / seek authorisation.

ACCEPTABLE USAGE POLICY (AUP)

Our AUP is part of the IPP and gives you specific guidance on the proper use and protection of our corporate information resources (e.g. email, internet, workstations, applications, mobile devices etc.) When It comes to Technology and Communications our information systems may not be used to engage in prohibited conduct, such as communicating or viewing discriminatory, harassing, sexually explicit or otherwise offensive or inappropriate material.

They may not be used to download entertainment software, play games over the internet, or download unlicensed images, music or videos, or to store music or videos other than those appropriately licensed for professional use and used accordingly. In addition, our IT systems may not be used to engage in any other activities that involve

unlawful and unauthorised distribution of content online or which may violate intellectual property rights, whether or not such activities undermine the rights of a Firm client.

If the Firm has provided you with a computer, cell phone or other portable technology, you are required to use that technology appropriately and in accordance with Firm policies. These policies always apply to Firm equipment and do not change after hours or when traveling.

13.6 DIGITAL CODE OF ETHICS

We are all increasingly exposed to social media. When you participate in social media, do not state personal opinions on behalf of the Firm unless you are authorised to do so.

Every project, design and site that you see or shoot has copyrights of either the designer, owner, artist or creator. Learn to respect that and do not go about taking pictures without seeking permission.

Do not attack or malign personally or as a group any person, product, customer, supplier, colleague or any other stakeholder.

INTERNET AND SOCIAL MEDIA

Social media, which may include apps like Snapchat or Instagram, or other Internet networking applications like Facebook or linkedin, should not be used during work hours except if it relates to business. Employees who spend inappropriate amounts of time on personal social media accounts during work hours will be subject to poor performance reviews.

Although social media should not be used at work, employees are expected to handle their personal social media accounts appropriately outside of the office. Employees should always work to ensure that their personal accounts clearly state that their views do not represent our organisation. Employees should never share any intellectual property, or the status of any of their assignments on social media.

When representing the Firm, employees should always be respectful and avoid speaking in specifics about their work. Employees should never post discriminatory, offensive, or other illegal language on social media. Employees must always correct or remove statements posted to their social media that are made on behalf of the Firm

DEALING WITH THE NEWS MEDIA

Media relations are an important part of building awareness of the capabilities and strengths of our Firm. They are a key component of enhancing and protecting our reputation. However, dealing with the news media is not without risk. So it is important that we approach media relations with care.

Only partners and authorized professionals may speak with or respond to media contacts and queries on behalf of the Firm. Partners should comment only in their specific areas of competence.

13.7 PRIVACY AND PROTECTION OF PERSONAL DATA:

We value and safeguard the privacy of all our employees, job applicants, business partners and consumers. It is everyone's responsibility to adhere to the following core principles when we handle personal data:

1. Process data lawfully, fairly and in a transparent manner.
2. Collect data for specified, explicit and legitimate purposes only.
3. Do not collect or process data you do not need.
4. Keep data accurate and up to date.
5. Limit how long you keep collected data.
6. Ensure appropriate security of personal data.

14 VIOLATION OF CODE.

PHXINDIA LLP holds each of its employees to certain work rules and codes of conduct. When an employee deviates from these rules and standards, PHXINDIA LLP expects the employee's team leaders to take action.

Though committed to a progressive approach to disciplinary action, PHXINDIA LLP considers certain rule infractions and violations of standards as grounds for immediate termination of employment.

These include but are not limited to:

- I. Unauthorised access to Firm property outside of business hours.
- II. Using Firm equipment and/or Firm vehicles without authorisation.
- III. Theft.
- IV. Insubordination.
- V. Vandalism or destruction of Firm property.
- VI. Misrepresentations of PHXINDIA LLP to a customer, a prospective customer, the general public, or an employee.
- VII. Sharing Firm business practices.

DISCIPLINARY ACTIONS :

Our Firm may have to take disciplinary action against employees who repeatedly or intentionally fail to follow our code of conduct. Disciplinary actions will vary depending on the violation. Some of the consequences include:

- a. Penalties and fines.
- b. Demotion.
- c. Reprimand.
- d. Suspension or termination for more serious offences. Involuntary withdrawal for partners
- e. Detraction of benefits for a definite or indefinite time.

- f. Violators also maybe subject to civil or criminal sanctions. We may take legal action in cases of corruption, theft, embezzlement or other unlawful behaviour

15. EMPLOYMENT TERMINATION.

Our **Termination/Separation of Employment policy** refers to the event that an employee ceases to be part of the company's workforce. It is beneficial for all parties that the employment separation process is as clear as possible so misunderstandings and distrust between the employee and the company can be avoided. The company is bound to handle any cases of termination of employment as dictated by law with discretion, professionalism and official documentation.

This termination/separation of employment policy applies to all prospective or current employees of the company in regards to possible separation of employment.

The dismissal of an employee from their job duties may be categorised as voluntary or involuntary.

VOLUNTARY DISMISSAL

- A. Resignation
- B. Retirement (Age 60 years. Subject to management decision and fines test)
- C. Expiration or completion of contract
- D. Failure to show for a specified number of days without notice

INVOLUNTARY DISMISSAL

- E. Discharge for cause (disciplinary action or misconduct/ breach of code)
- F. Discharge without cause (lay-off, restructuring etc)

In case of points 15 / A, C & F, Employees shall give at least 2 weeks written notice before resigning from their position in the firm. Team Leaders and Managers have to give 4 weeks notice or until such time that their responsibilities are handed over smoothly to the employee taking over their position.

Professionals and technical staff will also have to give a 4 weeks notice before signing and also sign a Non-disclosure and fair trade practice agreement.

In case of Lay off or Discharge without cause, the company will give them one months notice or Pay in Lieu (based on the last basic salary drawn) for the period.

In case of Points 15 D, E, the termination can be with immediate effect and with no accrued benefits attached. The decision of the management is final and abiding.

Employees who terminate employment with **PHXINDIA LLP** shall return Firm property.

No final employee's payment will be made until all items are returned in appropriate condition. Cost of replacing un-returned items is deducted from the employee's final

pay. Any outstanding financial obligations owed to **PHXINDIA LLP** will also be deducted from the employee's final pay.

Benefits are affected by employment termination in the following manner:

PHXINDIA LLP will pay accrued vested benefits due and payable at termination. Some benefits may be continued at employee expense. The employee will be informed of benefits that may be continued and how to do so.

The accrued benefits if any, and rewards / employment benefits due to the employee will not be settled if the notice period and termination clause is not adhered to and if the termination is based on Point 15 D and 15E. Refer to the Termination Policy document with Admin for more clarity.

16. CELL PHONE POLICY

The **PHXINDIA LLP** cell phone policy offers general guidelines for using personal and Firm cell phones during work hours. The purpose of this policy is to help us all get the most out of the advantages cell phones offer our Firm while minimising distractions, accidents, and frustrations improper cell phone use can cause. This policy applies to all **PHXINDIA LLP** employees.

CELL PHONE USE GUIDELINES:

The following are **PHXINDIA LLP**'s basic guidelines for proper employee cell phone use during work hours. In general, cell phones should not be used when they could pose a security or safety risk, or when they distract from work tasks:

1. Never use a cell phone while driving.
2. Never use a cell phone while operating equipment.
3. Do not use cell phones for surfing the internet or gaming during work hours.
4. Avoid using work cell phones for personal tasks.
5. If a company number is provided, avoid using personal cell phones for work tasks.
6. Do not use cell phones during meetings. Keep it on silent mode during meetings.
7. Do not use cell phones to record confidential information.

We realise the cell phones can be great tools for our employees. We encourage employees to use cell phones when:

1. For making or receiving work calls in the appropriate place and situation to do so.
2. For other work-related communication, such as text messaging or emailing in appropriate places and situations.
3. To schedule and keep track of appointments.
4. To carry out work-related research.
5. To keep track of work tasks.

6. To keep track of work contacts.

Disciplinary Action

- a. Improper use of cell phones may result in disciplinary action. Continued use of cell phones at inappropriate times or in ways that distract from work may lead to having cell phone privileges revoked.
- b. Cell phone usage for illegal or dangerous activity, for purposes of harassment, or in ways that violate the Firm confidentiality policy may result in employee termination.

17. CONCLUSION

PHXINDIA LLP aspires to be a different kind of Firm. It's impossible to spell out every possible ethical scenario we might face. Instead, we rely on one another's good judgment to uphold a high standard of integrity for ourselves and our Firm. We expect all PHXINDIA LLP's to be guided by both the letter and the spirit of this Code. Sometimes, identifying the right thing to do isn't an easy call. If you aren't sure, don't be afraid to ask questions of your Admin.

Please sign the acceptance sheet in the office to complete the procedure.

1. SEBASTIAN ZACHARIAH

.....

2. IRA GOSALIA

.....

3. AADITYA KULKARNI

.....

4. MAITREYI HONAVER

.....

5. JANVI THAKKAR

.....

6. RANJAN VARMA

.....

7. MILIND NALAWADE

.....

8. CHANDRAKANT RATHOD

.....

9. PAYAL PATEL

.....

10. SIDDHESH BERDE

.....

11. URVI KOTHARI

.....

12. ROHIT MENDIRATTA

.....

13. JACOB NEDUMCHIRA

.....

14. SANAT GABA

.....

15. ALISHA MEMON

.....

16. SWARAN SINGH BELA

17.

HOW DO YOU DECIDE?

The above sections of our Code explain our compliance obligations and Firm standards in a number of specific areas. Many of these standards are a starting point. They do not address specific local laws, regulations and professional standards, which you also need to consider and comply with.

You may encounter circumstances where the Firm does not have a policy or standard. Or you may not be certain that a policy is applicable to the facts in front of you. If so, ask yourself these questions to help you make the right choices and do the right things:

- Does it violate the law or professional ethics?
- Is it inconsistent with the letter and spirit of this Code?
- Would I be embarrassed if friends or family knew I did this?
- Could this cause harm to the Firm or damage to its reputation?
- Could this cause physical, emotional or other harm to someone?
- Would I be embarrassed if this were reported in a blog or news story?

If you can answer “no” to all of these questions, you are likely to be on safe ground. If you say “yes” or “I’m not sure” to any of them, seek guidance.

Our Client Service Principles encourage us to get to know our clients personally and “turn relationships into friendships.” But we must always keep in mind that client relationships are business relationships and certain lines must not be crossed.

- We expect you to have read this Code and agree to abide by our principles, policies and standards.
- We expect you to seek guidance when you have questions about the Code or its application.
- And, to the extent permissible under local privacy and employment laws, we expect you to report any violations you learn about or suspect.
- All of us share in the benefits of PHXINDIA LLP’s good name. We also share a responsibility to preserve and promise to protect it.

Thank you for doing your part!!